

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Information Governance Lawyer role at the Wokingham local authority, as advertised through Service Care Solutions. My background combines practical information governance work, legal research across UK and EU data protection frameworks, and client-facing advisory experience — making me well placed to contribute to your Legal & Information Governance team from day one.

At Q-Legal, I managed a data privacy matter from instruction through to a formal written advice letter under solicitor supervision. I researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations in depth — including children's personal data and adtech — identified compliance risks in the client's data processing, and translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused recommendations. That matter required both technical accuracy and practical judgement about proportionate mitigation, which I understand sits at the heart of information governance work in a local authority context.

At Adobe, I reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions across software licensing agreements, assessed alignment with UK and EU GDPR, and researched cross-border personal data transfer requirements. Liaising across sales, legal and international business teams to reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk gave me an early grounding in the practical tensions that information governance practitioners navigate daily.

My LLM dissertation — awarded a Distinction at 75% — examined the development of GDPR across jurisdictions, and my LLM programme more broadly covered evidence analysis, procedural issues and legal research methodology. That academic foundation complements my hands-on experience and supports the kind of careful, well-reasoned advice a local authority's information governance function needs to produce.

At Citizens Advice, I advise clients on complex regulatory and statutory frameworks, draft correspondence and maintain confidential records — experience that has sharpened both my attention to detail and my ability to communicate clearly with non-specialist audiences. I am based in Maidenhead and the Wokingham location suits me well.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my information governance experience and wider legal background can support the team. I am available at short notice and happy to provide further detail on any aspect of my application.

Yours faithfully,
Maria Fernanda Silva